BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Travel Planning & Booking Application

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Project Name: SKY Travels (temp name)

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Document purpose: Define the business problem, objectives, users, scope, and expected capabilities of a travel application before detailed design and development begin.

1. Project Overview

The Travel Planning & Booking Application will help travellers discover destinations, plan trips, organise itineraries, estimate expenses, and access accommodation or transport booking options in one place. The first release is intended as a practical MVP (minimum viable product); actual reservations and payments depend on integration with suitable third-party providers.

2. Business Problem

Travellers often use multiple websites and apps to research destinations, compare options, organise daily plans, and track trip expenses. Information can become scattered, making trip preparation time-consuming and difficult to manage.

3. Business Objectives

- Provide one convenient place to discover destinations and build trip plans.
- Allow users to create, edit, and view day-by-day itineraries.
- Help users estimate and track a trip budget.
- Present useful destination information, including attractions and travel tips.
- Provide clear links or integrations for accommodation and transport options.
- Offer an accessible, mobile-friendly experience that reduces planning effort.

4. Target Users / Stakeholders

- Guest visitor: explores destinations and public travel information.
- Registered traveller: saves destinations, creates trips, manages itineraries, and tracks budgets.

- Administrator: manages destination content, categories, reports, and inappropriate or outdated information.
- External providers: map, weather, transport, accommodation, or payment services integrated where required.
- Project team: product owner, designer, developer, and tester.

5. Functional Requirements

ID / Feature	Requirement
FR-01: Registration and login	Users can register, log in, log out, and securely manage their profile. Guests may browse public content.
FR-02: Destination discovery	Users can browse and search destinations by name, region, category, or interests.
FR-03: Destination details	The app displays available descriptions, images, attractions, suggested activities, travel tips, and estimated costs.
FR-04: Trip creation	Registered users can create a trip with a title, destination, start date, end date, and number of travellers.
FR-05: Itinerary management	Users can add, edit, reorder, and remove activities or places by day.
FR-06: Budget management	Users can set a budget and record estimated or actual expenses by category, such as transport, stay, food, and activities.
FR-07: Saved places	Users can bookmark destinations and attractions for later.
FR-08: Maps and directions	Where a map provider is available, users can view locations and open directions.
FR-09: Booking information	The app can show or link to third-party transport and accommodation options. In-app confirmation is only included if provider APIs support it.
FR-10: Notifications	The app may send trip reminders or itinerary updates when notification services are configured.
FR-11: Admin content management	Administrators can add, edit, publish, or remove destination and attraction information.
FR-12: Feedback and support	Users can submit feedback or report incorrect destination information.

6. Non-Functional Requirements

- Usability: Common tasks should be understandable to first-time users, with clear navigation and helpful validation.
- Responsive design: Core screens should work on mobile phones, tablets, and desktop browsers.
- Performance: Main screens and searches should load promptly under normal network conditions.
- Security: Passwords must not be stored in plain text; access to private trips and profile data must be controlled.
- Privacy: Collect only necessary personal data and explain how it is used.
- Reliability: Show clear errors when a third-party API is unavailable; do not present failed bookings as confirmed.
- Maintainability: Keep destination data, trip logic, and external integrations organised so they can be updated independently.
- Accessibility: Use readable contrast, labels, keyboard support, and meaningful alternative text where applicable.

7. Business Rules

- A user must be authenticated to save a personal trip or modify their itinerary.
- A trip end date must be the same as or later than its start date.
- A budget and expense amount cannot be negative.
- Only authorised administrators may publish or remove shared destination content.
- A third-party booking is confirmed only when the provider returns a valid confirmation; a link-out is not a booking.
- Prices, opening hours, weather, visa guidance, and availability may change and should display source or last-updated information where possible.

8. Project Scope

In scope for the proposed MVP

- Account creation and login.
- Destination listing, search, and detail pages.
- Personal trip creation and day-by-day itinerary editing.
- Basic budget and expense tracking.
- Saved destinations and attractions.
- Basic admin management of destination content.
- Responsive user interface and basic error handling.

Potential later-phase features

- Live flight, train, bus, and hotel search through provider APIs.
- In-app payments, refunds, and reservation management.
- Collaborative trip planning with friends.
- AI-generated itineraries and personalised recommendations.
- Offline maps or downloadable itineraries.
- Multi-language and multi-currency support.

Out of scope for the initial MVP

- Operating transport or accommodation services directly.
- Guaranteeing third-party prices, schedules, availability, or entry requirements.
- Providing emergency response or acting as an insurer.
- Processing bookings or payments unless a provider integration is explicitly approved.

9. Assumptions

- Users have access to a smartphone or web browser and an internet connection for online features.
- Destination content can be entered by administrators or sourced from permitted APIs.
- Third-party map, weather, and booking APIs may require keys, usage limits, or paid plans.
- The initial release can use booking links if direct booking APIs are unavailable.
- The project team will confirm the launch geography and supported currencies before implementation.

10. Constraints and Dependencies

- Budget, team size, and delivery deadline have not yet been confirmed.
- Features relying on external providers depend on their API access, pricing, terms, and uptime.

- Personal data and payments must be handled according to applicable laws and provider requirements.
- Accurate live information depends on the freshness and reliability of third-party data.

11. High-Level User Flow

Open app → Browse/search destinations → View destination details → Register/log in → Create trip → Add dates and travellers → Build itinerary → Set budget → Save trip → Optionally open external booking links → Review trip plan

12. Success Criteria

- A user can create an account and sign in successfully.
- A user can find a destination using search or browsing.
- A registered user can create, edit, and reopen a saved trip.
- A user can add itinerary items and see them grouped by day.
- A user can record expenses and view the remaining budget.
- An administrator can update destination content.
- Errors from unavailable external services are communicated clearly and do not create false booking confirmations.

13. Risks and Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Outdated destination information	Show update dates and provide an admin workflow to review content.
Third-party API limits or cost	Confirm provider terms early; use a modular integration and fallback links.
Scope becoming too large	Deliver the MVP first and treat live bookings/AI features as later phases.
Privacy or account security issues	Use established authentication practices, access controls, and minimal data collection.
Unclear booking status	Clearly distinguish information links, pending requests, and provider-confirmed bookings.

14.Resources and Technologies Required

- Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and React for the user interface.
- Styling: Tailwind CSS or regular CSS for responsive page design.
- Backend:Python,Fast API (Rest API).
- Database: MySQL.
- Maps: OpenStreetMap, or Google Maps API
- Design: Figma for wireframes and UI planning
- Version control: Git and GitHub.
- Testing: Browser developer tools and manual functional testing.

15. Acceptance and Approval

This BRD should be reviewed by all the members of the project before detailed software requirements, UI/UX design, database design, and implementation begin.